KARANDAAZ PAKISTAN

REQUEST FOR EXPRESSION OF INTEREST

Digital and Financial Capability Training for BISP Beneficiaries

Country	**Pakistan**
EOI Reference No.	27
Project Title	Digital and Financial Capability Training for BISP Beneficiaries
Programme	Karandaaz Digital – Supporting G2P Digitization in Pakistan
Issuing Organization	Karandaaz Pakistan
Assignment Duration	Approximately 18 – 24 months (indicative – firm may propose duration based on its own assessment)
EOI Issue Date	16 July, 2026
Last date for Queries:	27 July, 2026
Response to Queries:	29 July, 2026
Last Date for Submission	10 August, 2026
Queries / Clarifications	procurement@karandaaz.com.pk
Address EOI response to:	Procurement Department
Who can Apply	Firms, or consortiums/joint ventures

1. Introduction

Karandaaz Pakistan is a not-for-profit company established in 2014 and registered with the Securities and Exchange Commission of Pakistan ("SECP") under Section 42 of the Companies Act,2017. Karandaaz Pakistan promotes access to finance for micro, small, and medium enterprises (MSMEs) and advances financial inclusion for individuals by leveraging technology-enabled solutions and platforms. Karandaaz Pakistan operates across multiple program verticals including Karandaaz Capital, Karandaaz Digital, Karandaaz Innovation, and Karandaaz Research & Insights.

Karandaaz Pakistan's founding was supported by a seed grant from the UK Government's Foreign, Commonwealth & Development Office (FCDO), with subsequent support for its digital financial services work provided through grants, including from the Gates Foundation. Karandaaz Digital focuses on expanding access to digital financial services in Pakistan by working closely with regulators, policymakers, government entities, financial service providers, and ecosystem stakeholders across policy and regulation, experimentation, solutions development, and scale-up.

2. Background and Rationale

A shift to Raast-enabled, account-based disbursements under the Benazir Income Support Programme ("BISP") is not merely a change in payment rails, it represents a structural transition from cash access to genuine financial participation. While full-mandate accounts remove the supply-side constraints inherent in Limited Mandate Accounts (LMAs), they do not automatically translate into meaningful usage or empowerment. Without deliberate investment in digital and financial capability, there is a high risk that beneficiaries will continue to exhibit "cash-out only" behavior, effectively replicating the limitations of the current system on new infrastructure.

The rationale for capability-building of approximately **one million BISP beneficiaries** is to bridge the last-mile gap between access and usage. Women receiving payments into their own accounts, and operating SIMs and mobile wallets

registered to their CNICs, are being positioned as independent financial actors for the first time. Evidence from Pakistan and comparable markets shows that first-generation users, particularly low-income women, face barriers including low functional literacy, limited familiarity with digital interfaces, trust deficits in formal financial systems, and socio-cultural constraints on independent financial decision-making.

To support BISP in ensuring an effective transition, Karandaaz Pakistan intends to engage an experienced firm (or consortium/joint venture) to design and implement a nationwide Digital and Financial Capability Building program to build beneficiaries', particularly women's digital readiness and confidence to navigate the digital financial system.

3. Objective of the Assignment

The primary objective of this assignment is to support BISP in preparing its beneficiaries for the transition to digital accounts by building their digital and financial capabilities through a structurally blended training program for approximately **one million beneficiaries**, which can later be scaled to BISP's entire beneficiary base. Specific objectives include:

- Beneficiaries demonstrate functional digital readiness;
- Beneficiaries exhibit improved financial knowledge, confidence, and capability;
- Beneficiaries successfully onboard and complete initial digital transactions;
- Beneficiaries transition from one-time access to active and sustained usage of digital financial services;
- BISP develops institutional capacity through a certified pool of master trainers; and,
- A context-appropriate blended (physical/digital) training model is designed and deployed at scale.

4. Scope of Services

The selected firm will be responsible for the end-to-end design, adaptive implementation, and continuous reporting of the training program. The broad components of work shall include:

- Diagnostic, Curriculum Design & Capacity Building – baseline assessment, beneficiary segmentation, task-based curriculum design, localized and gender-intentional content, and Training of Trainers (ToT) for BISP master trainers.
- Roll-Out Planning & Go-to-Market Strategy – a comprehensive nationwide rollout strategy, including a dedicated blended training deployment plan justifying the physical-to-digital modality split, channel mapping, and sequencing across the beneficiary journey.
- Field Implementation, Beneficiary Training & Behavioural Reinforcement structured training delivery to approximately one million beneficiaries, integrated digital reinforcement, and onboarding support.

The program is expected to follow a phased rollout, with a structured review and course-correction gate between phases. The full scope of work, deliverables, and payment milestones will be detailed in the complete Terms of Reference (TORs) and Request for Proposals (RFP) which shall be shared with shortlisted/eligible firms.

5. Eligibility and Required Competencies

Interested firms, or consortiums/joint ventures, must be able to demonstrate the following competencies, supported by CVs, project references, and a description of relevant experience:

- Financial and Digital Literacy Expertise – demonstrated experience designing and implementing financial and digital literacy programs for low-literacy and marginalized populations, particularly women.

- Content Development and Sector Methodology – proven capability developing blended (physical and digital) training curricula and content for low-literacy, women-centric audiences, and experience working with relevant ecosystem actors (SBP, social safety net programs, banks, mobile banking operators, telecoms, agent/retailer networks, and public sector institutions).
- Digital Channel Deployment – demonstrated capability to design and deploy IVR, SMS, short-form video, and digital media content at scale in low-connectivity environments.
- Project Management and M&E Capability – demonstrated strength in field coordination, progress documentation, output verification, and data quality assurance.
- Qualified and Relevant Team Composition – availability of a technically qualified team spanning financial literacy, digital tools/DFS, gender and community engagement, training/facilitation, and field operations.
- Geographic Deployment and Delivery Capacity – operational infrastructure, field presence, and staffing depth to deliver a large-scale, multi-phase blended program across urban, peri-urban, and remote rural areas of Pakistan. Pulse, CLICK,D4D, DFLT Phase 2

Applications may be submitted by a single firm, or a consortium/joint venture of firms. Where a consortium/joint venture applies, the roles, responsibilities, and coordination mechanisms among its members must be clearly defined.

7. Information Requested at EOI Stage

Interested and eligible firms and consortia/joint ventures are requested to submit an Expression of Interest comprising:

- A cover letter confirming interest in and eligibility for the assignment;
- The entity's (company, partnership, or consortium/joint venture) profile, including legal status, registration documents, and years of operation;
- A summary of relevant experience and track record, including at least 2 comparable assignments (financial/digital literacy, low-literacy or women-centric training programs, or social safety net program engagements), with client references;
- Brief CVs of proposed key personnel (indicative team lead and technical specialists);
- A short concept note (maximum 2–3 pages) outlining the firm's proposed approach to blended (physical/digital) training delivery at scale; and
- Evidence of financial standing and capacity to mobilize and deliver a national-scale, multi-phase program. Annexure - C : Rahat

Bidders who meet the pre-requisites will be invited through an RFP to submit a detailed Technical and Financial Proposals.

- The decisions of Karandaaz Pakistan will be final. Karandaaz Pakistan reserves the right to cancel the bidding process and to reject all bids or to accept or reject any bid, at any time prior to the award of the contract, without thereby incurring any liability to the affected bidder or bidders or any obligation to inform the affected bidder or bidders of the grounds for Karandaaz Pakistan's action.

- **No contractual obligation whatsoever shall arise from the EOI/Bidding process**.

8. Evaluation of EOIs

Expressions of Interest shall be evaluated in two stages:

- Stage 1 – Mandatory Eligibility Screening : Each EOI is screened against the mandatory eligibility criteria as provided in Section 8.1 on a pass/fail basis. Only EOIs meeting all mandatory criteria shall proceed to Stage 2.

- Stage 2 – Shortlisting for the RFP Stage: Eligible entities shall be shortlisted based on the strength of the information submitted at EOI stage (relevant experience, proposed approach, team, and financial standing) and shall be invited to submit full Technical and Financial Proposals under the detailed TORs/RFP.

8.1 Stage 1 – Mandatory Technical Eligibility Checklist (Yes/No)

Entities are required to complete the Yes/No self-declaration below and provide supporting evidence for each criterion as part of their EOI submission. Only EOIs marked "Yes" against all mandatory criteria will be considered eligible for shortlisting.

S.No	Mandatory Technical Eligibility Criteria	Yes	No
1	Copy of the Entity's Registration Document (Single entity or consortium/joint venture)	☐	☐
2	Copy of Tax Certificate (Single entity or Lead entity)	☐	☐
3	Where applying as a consortium/joint venture, a signed consortium/joint venture agreement or letter of intent defining roles, responsibilities, and coordination mechanisms is included.	☐	☐
4	Demonstrated experience of at least 5 years designing and/or implementing financial and/or digital literacy programs for low-literacy or marginalized populations.	☐	☐
5	At least 2 prior assignments specifically targeting women beneficiaries or women-centric financial/digital inclusion programs, with client references provided.	☐	☐
6	Demonstrated prior experience working with government, public sector, or social safety net programs (e.g., BISP or similar national programs).	☐	☐
7	Demonstrated capability to design and/or deploy at least one digital/technology-enabled channel (IVR, SMS, short-form video, or digital media) for a training or awareness program.	☐	☐
8	Available technically qualified team covering financial literacy, digital tools/DFS, gender and community engagement, training/facilitation, and field operations, with CVs provided. Provide signed document by the competent authority on the entity's letterhead – **Annexure A..**	☐	☐
9	Demonstrated operational/field presence and capacity to deliver a multi-region program in Pakistan, including urban, peri-urban, and rural areas.	☐	☐
10	Do you have evidence of sound financial standing and adequate financial capacity relative to the size of this assignment? Please provide audited reports of the entity's financial statements for the year 2024-25.	☐	☐
11	Do you have the operational capacity to implement nationwide trainings in Pakistan? Please attach list of information regarding local and regional offices	☐	☐
12	The firm or consortium/joint venture members are not currently blacklisted or debarred by any government, donor, or development partner in Pakistan or	☐	☐

S.No	Mandatory Technical Eligibility Criteria	Yes	No
	elsewhere. Provide signed document by the competent authority on the entity's letterhead – **Annexure B**		
13	Acceptance of all Karandaaz Pakistan's conditions given in this EOI	☐	☐
14	The proposed team comprises overseas nationals, a certificate must be provided that those individuals will be able to travel to Pakistan and remain in Pakistan as and when required for the assignment. Nationals, Permanent residents or people originating from India and/or Israel must not be included in the proposed team even if they hold dual nationality and a passport from any other country	☐	☐

Note: *All documents as evidence to be provided with the bid document. EOIs marked "No" against any mandatory criterion, or submitted without supporting evidence, may be declared non-responsive at Karandaaz Pakistan's sole discretion.

9. QUERIES

All questions and/or clarifications regarding this EOI, if any, must be submitted via the following email address: procurement@karandaaz.com.pk, **no later than 5:00 PM Pakistan Standard Time on or before 22 July 2026**. No queries / clarifications regarding this EOI will be entertained after this deadline. All correspondence and/or inquiries regarding this EOI must reference the EOI number.

10. CLARIFICATION TO EOI

List of the questions raised and the responses given will be uploaded at Karandaaz Pakistan website under the procurement section by **10:00 PM Pakistan Standard Time on 27th July 2026.**

No phone calls or in-person inquiries will be entertained; all questions and inquiries must be in writing.

Only written answers will be considered in the EOI process and subsequent evaluation. Any verbal information received from a Karandaaz Pakistan employee or other entity should not be considered as an official response to any questions regarding this EOI.

11. Scored Technical Evaluation (Full Proposal Stage)

This EOI is a pre-qualification step. Any entity found eligible and shortlisted based on the information submitted will be invited through a Request for Proposals (RFP) to submit detailed Technical and Financial Proposals in response to the complete Terms of Reference (TORs). Unsuccessful entities shall be informed via email after the completion of Stage 1 of the process.

12. Submission Instructions

The envelope marked "Pre-requisites" should be sealed and **must contain one hard copy** of each the required documents. Entities who do not provide the mandatory information required to be submitted under this EOI will not be considered for evaluation. This envelope containing the booklet should also contain the completed checklist with evidence. The envelope should:

- Include the name and address of the entity; and,
- Have "**EOI 27**" for **"Digital and Financial Capability Training for BISP Beneficiaries"** clearly marked**.**

EOIs must also be submitted electronically through email (with subject: **EOI # 27** "**Digital and Financial Capability Training for BISP Beneficiaries**") at or before 05:00 PM Pakistan Standard Time, August 10, 2026; procurement@karandaaz.com.pk.

The hard copies must be received or post-marked by August 10, 2026. Hard copies will be courier to:
1 E, Ali Plaza, Nazimuddin Road, D-Chowk, Islamabad, Pakistan.

Documents submitted in response to EOI after the closing date will **NOT** be accepted.

Karandaaz Pakistan reserves the right to accept or reject any or all Expressions of Interest without assigning any reason, and to modify the timeline, scope, or process at its discretion.

Annexure - A

[LETTERHEAD OF THE ENTITY]

UNDERTAKING REGARDING AVAILABILTIY OF THE PROJECT TEAM

It is hereby certified by **[Name of Organizations]** that the proposed team members mentioned in the Expression of Interest (EOI) and any subsequent project team members will be made available at the project site as per the requirement of the project.

In case of replacement of any proposed team member under extenuating and unforeseen circumstances a resource person with similar or better qualifications and experience will be made available after prior approval of Karandaaz.

Name of Signatory:

Signature of Authorized Signatory

Date: __/___/____

Company stamp:

Annexure - B

[LETTERHEAD OF THE ENTITY]

UNDERTAKING REGARDING NOT BEING BLACKLISTING

It is hereby certified that, **[Name of Organization]** has not been blacklisted by any Government, Agency / authority **as on [Date]**. **[Name of Organization]** will immediately inform Karandaaz Pakistan in case of any change in the status any time hereinafter.

It is further certified that **[Name of Organization]** or any of its personnel, agents or, suppliers and/or their employees are not directly or indirectly engaged in or support individuals, groups or entities associated with terrorism, including but not limited to the following:

a. HM Treasury's Office of Financial Sanction Implementation-Financial sanctions consolidated list of targets;
b. UK Home Office- Proscribed terrorist groups or organisations;
c. United Nations- United Nations Security Council Sanctions List;
d. World Bank- World Bank Listing of Ineligible Firms and Individuals.
e. European Union- Consolidated List of Sanctions;
f. Parties on US Treasury's Office of Foreign Assets Control (OFAC) List of Specially Designated Nationals and Blocked Persons
g. National Counter Terrorism Authority (NACTA)- Proscribed Organizations List;
h. National Counter Terrorism Authority (NACTA)-Proscribed Persons List
i. French DG Trésor Freeze Register Sanctions List

Name of Signatory:

Signature of Authorized Signatory

Date: __/___/____

Company stamp: